

3:6	5:11	1:6	3:24
και	ο θεος ημιν	περιπατουμεν	--- εν
---	2492	---	---
---	---	2544	---
---	---	2652	---
---	---	---	2805
8	16	13	10

As with James, there is no overlap between the first two columns (in James the 1st column does share one MS with the 2nd, but none with the 3rd and 5th), and only one MS in common between the 2nd and 3rd! It follows that **f**³⁵ is independent of all the lines of transmission represented by the MSS in those columns. There are no Byzantine MSS in the 1st column and only one (not very strong—69) in the 2nd. In contrast, the 3rd column has one very strong Byzantine MS (607), one strong one (180), two fair ones (0142, 1890), and two weak ones (1501, 1842); for all that, they obviously do not represent the bulk of the Byzantine tradition. As in James, **f**³⁵ is clearly early and independent of **K**^x. If it is independent of all other lines of transmission as well, as I believe I can demonstrate, then it harks back to the Original—what other reasonable explanation is there?

Family 35 represents about 16% of the total of extant MSS, but it is almost never entirely alone. However, as illustrated above, the sprinkling of other MSS is almost never the same. So again I ask: How is that diverse sprinkling to be explained? Does it not indicate that **f**³⁵ is the core from which a great many tangents departed? What other reasonable explanation is there? If it is the core, then it represents the Original. (I am assuming a reasonably normal transmission, which I have defended elsewhere.)

I invite the reader to pause and really think about the implications of the evidence presented above (trying to set aside preconceived ideas). It has been standard procedure for partisans of a certain theoretical orientation to insist upon the difference between individual readings and a text-type. I agree that these must be distinguished. However, it is the mosaic, or profile, or selection of individual readings that define a text-type, or family, or line of transmission. **If all the individual readings that define a family are demonstrably ancient, then perforce the family itself is ancient!**

I suppose it could be theoretically possible for someone in the eighth century to concoct a new archetype, using only early readings; but what possible reason could anyone have for doing so? And how could such a concocted text spread throughout the Mediterranean world? And how could it achieve a level of loyalty far exceeding that in any other line of